STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-3400
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **02/06/24**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT UNIFORM DECORATIONS	CROSS-REFERENCE		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for wearing uniform decorations indicating outstanding achievement or exceptional service.

II. Policy:

To recognize outstanding achievement and effort by sworn and civilian employees of the Sheriff's Office, distinguished service medals, awards and recognition pins may be presented. These uniform decorations may be worn as part of the standard brown sheriff's office uniforms and shall be worn when the dress uniform is required.

III. Procedures: Below is a description of medals, awards and recognition pins presented by the Sheriff's Office. They are listed in order of highest priority.

A. Distinguished Service Medals:

1. Medal of Honor:
Awarded to an employee who distinguishes himself or herself by gallantry and courage at the risk of his or her life beyond the call of duty. This is the highest award bestowed by the Sheriff's Office.

2. Lifesaving Medal:
Awarded to an employee that performs a lifesaving activity. Examples may be life saving C.P.R., or rescue from fire or drowning.

3. Medal of Valor:
Awarded to an employee who performs a dangerous and/or distinguished act of conspicuous bravery or heroism above and beyond the performance that is normally expected. The employee's actions may have placed himself or herself in danger of injury, resulted in injury to the acting employee or prevented or minimized injury to another, but may not have been life threatening.

B. Service Awards:

1. Michael Elman/Ryan Fawcett Award:
Awarded annually by the FOP Lodge #3 to recognize an outstanding member.

2. Sworn Employee of the Year Award:
Awarded annually to the individual chosen by the Sheriff to be the sworn employee of the year.

3. Commendation Award:
Awarded to any employee that receives an official Letter of Commendation from the Sheriff recognizing effort that is exceptional. The number five (5) shall be placed on the award on the fifth commendation.

4. Length of Service Award**:**
This award shall be issued to sworn personnel who have 2, 5, 10 and 15 years of service, and for each consecutive five years thereafter. Only one length of service award shall be worn at a time. The design for each number of years is:

a) 2 years – Bar

b) 5 years – Star

c) 10 years – Diamond

d) 15 years – Star and Diamond

e) 20 years – Two Diamonds

f) 25 years – Star and two Diamonds

g) 30 years – Three Diamonds

h) 35+ years – Shield with number of years of service listed in the center

5. Veteran

C. Special Service Recognition Pins**:** Awarded to deputies who have been selected or volunteered to serve in special service units or have completed specialized training. Deputies awarded Special Service Recognition pins may wear them while they are an active member of their specific special service unit and are to remove the pin when no longer a member. Deputies that serve with a unit for ten (10) years or more shall have the special service pin awarded to them permanently.

1. Accident Investigator

2. Arson Investigator

3. Bike Patrol Unit

4. Crisis Negotiation Unit

5. Dive Team

6. Drone Team

7. SWAT

8. Field Force Unit

9. Field Training Officer

10. FTO Sergeant

11. FTO Lieutenant

12. Firearms Instructor

13. Honor Guard

14. K9 Handler

15. Mental Health Unit

16. Mobile Command Center

17. NA FBI Training

18. Northwestern Staff and Command Training:

19. Polygraph Examiner

20. School Resource Unit

21. Search and Rescue Unit

22. Instructor:
The instructor pin shall be issued to deputies who provide instruction in any area other than firearms (e.g., defensive tactics, emergency vehicle operations, domestic violence, TASER, etc.).

23. Community Service:
The Community Service pin shall be awarded to DARE/GREAT instructors, to the DARE/GREAT supervisor and any employee receiving the Community Service Award.

24. Olympic Security: Given to deputies who have been selected to provide security at any Olympic event.

25. Medical Certification/STACMed:
Awarded to an employee who holds a current certification as an Emergency Medical Technician, Paramedic or Registered Nurse.

26. Project Lifesaver:
Awarded to an employee who has successfully completed the Project Lifesaver electronic specialist certification and is involved with the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Project Lifesaver Program.

D. **"9-11-01 Never Forget" Pin:**

Every sworn employee wearing a uniform shall display a decoration pin in remembrance of the terrorist attack against the United States on September 11, 2001. The "9-11-01 Never Forget" decoration pin shall be worn along the top edge of the breast pocket and centered. This decoration pin shall not be worn with civilian clothing.

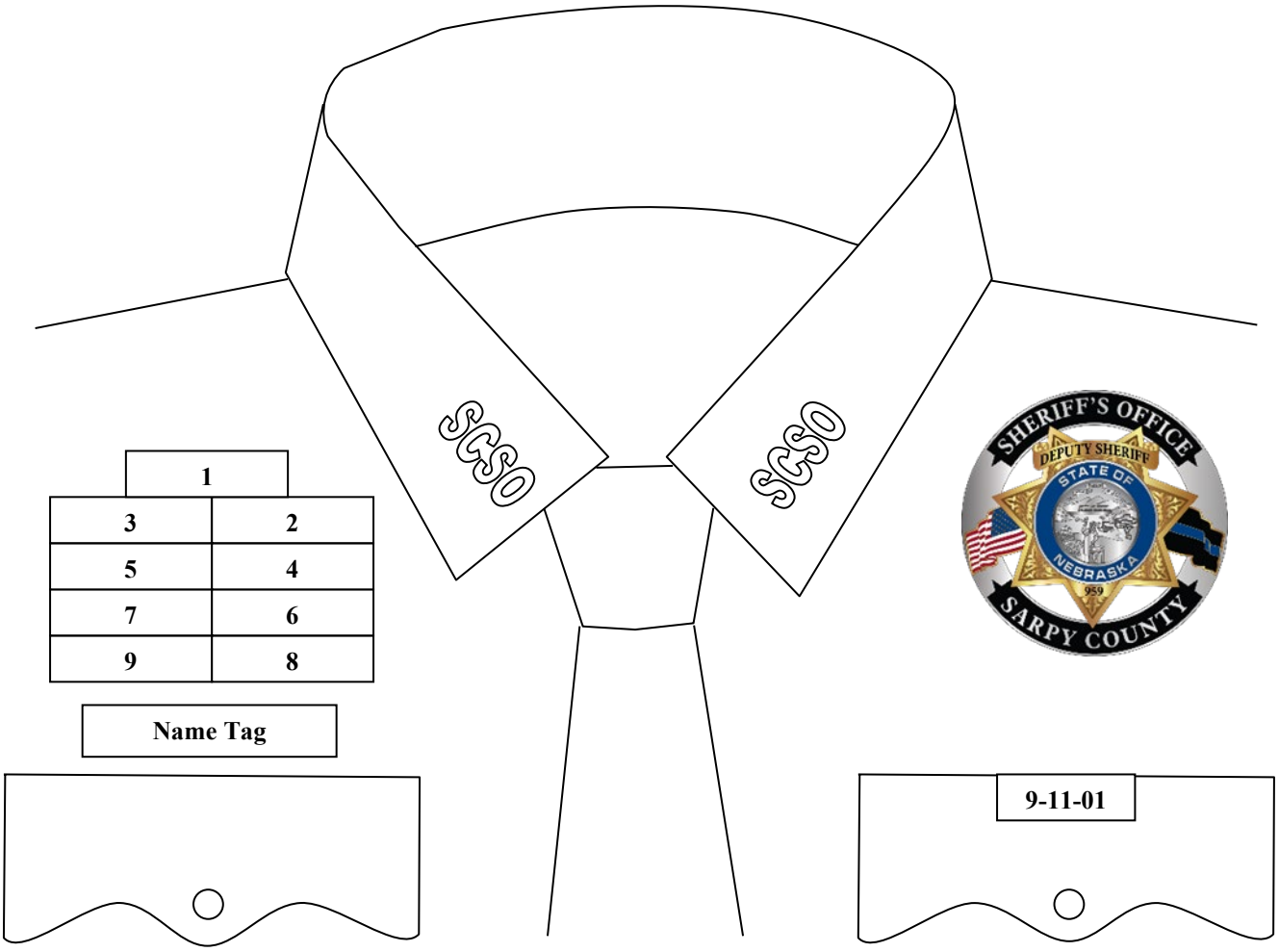
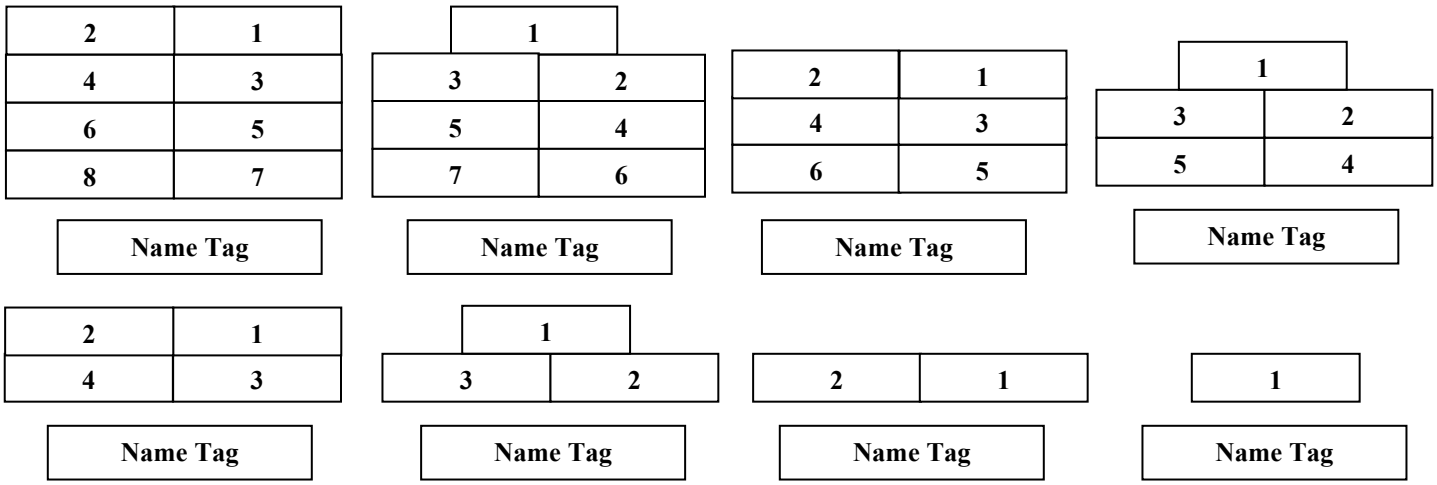
E. **Uniform Decoration Display:** Uniform decorations shall be worn in a specific order in descending priority. The decorations shall be worn above the right pocket and above the name tag. The maximum number of uniform decorations worn shall be nine (9) (excluding the 9-11-01 Never Forget pin).

1. Decorations shall be worn in the following order:

a) Medal of Honor
b) Lifesaving Award
c) Medal of Valor
d) Michael Elman Award
e) Sworn Employee of the Year Award

f) Commendation Award
g) Length of Service Award
h) Veteran Pin
i) Special Recognition Pin(s)

2. The diagram below shows the proper sequence for uniform decorations with numbers corresponding to placement by priority.



Additional Uniform Decoration Sequences: